

Forecast Watch: A Composite Country Risk Index, Kept Honest

Supporting evidence for Artemis Forecasting | Snapshot target year: 2024

Read this before the number
This is an ICRG/PRS-style structure, not licensed ICRG or PRS data. In the checked-in 2024 snapshot, IMF and World Bank Worldwide Governance Indicators (WGI) components could not be obtained and are marked missing. Each country's score therefore rests on the available Freedom House component alone; no missing value is imputed.

What the snapshot says

Scores run from 0 (lower observed risk) to 100 (higher observed risk). The four rows below are the actual committed outputs from PR #2. Because the two unavailable component groups are excluded and the remaining weight is renormalised, the composite equals the reversed Freedom House score in every row.

Country	Composite	Band	Available / missing
Russia (RUS)	88.00 / 100	VERY HIGH	Freedom House: 88.00; WGI: missing; IMF: missing
Iran (IRN)	89.00 / 100	VERY HIGH	Freedom House: 89.00; WGI: missing; IMF: missing
Venezuela (VEN)	87.00 / 100	VERY HIGH	Freedom House: 87.00; WGI: missing; IMF: missing
Syria (SYR)	95.00 / 100	VERY HIGH	Freedom House: 95.00; WGI: missing; IMF: missing

The displayed score is not evidence that the countries are identical across governance, macroeconomics, or civic freedom. It is a faithful rendering of an incomplete, one-component snapshot.

How the method is designed

When all component groups are present, governance has a 50% weight, macroeconomics 25%, and civic freedom 25%. If a group is missing, the available weights are renormalised. The intended transformations are:

Group	Open indicators	Transformation	Weight
Governance	World Bank WGI: government effectiveness	Reversed to risk: 100 - WGI score	50%
Macroeconomics	IMF DataMapper: real GDP growth and general government debt	Reversed to risk: 100 - (GDP growth + debt) / 2	25%
Civic freedom	Freedom House aggregate total	Reversed to risk: 100 - freedom total	25%

What it can - and cannot - validate

Use the index as a disciplined cross-check on a qualitative country judgment: does the direction look plausible, which component drives a disagreement, and what missing evidence should be collected next? It can challenge overconfident narrative, make assumptions explicit, and provide a repeatable baseline for later snapshots.

It cannot replace analyst judgment. The score does not model conflict exposure, sanctions, external financing, commodity concentration, exchange-rate stress, institutional nuance, or event timing. The weights and min/max mappings are policy choices, not empirically calibrated probabilities. WGI and Freedom House are perception and expert-coded measures with their own coverage and revisions. A very high band is a screening signal, not a forecast.

Provenance and limitations

The committed CSV, JSON, source manifest, and generator are in the Artemis Forecasting repository. The snapshot was generated for target year 2024; provider revisions may change a rerun. The source manifest records IMF 403 warnings and an empty observation set for the unavailable WGI snapshot.